Outlook

Re: [EXT] HEARTS Scale-Up Investment Case Paper

From AGBOYIBOR, Kouamivi Mawuenyegan <agboyibork@who.int>
Date Sun 9/27/2026 11:55 PM
To William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Cc David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>

Dear William,

This is very well received, thank you.
The age 20 and above is fine, WHO does not attend to narrow that.
For statin eligibility I will say:

- Had established cardiovascular disease (secondary prevention), or
- Had diabetes aged 40 years and older, or
- Had a 10-year cardiovascular disease risk ≥20% (primary prevention)

Would this not be possible we can consider:

- adults with diabetes aged 40 years and older and also
- adults with established ASCVD(secondary prevention).

Let me know your thoughts.

Kind regards,
Kouamivi

From: William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Sent: 27 September 2026 11:35 PM
To: AGBOYIBOR, Kouamivi Mawuenyegan <agboyibork@who.int>; David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>
Subject: Re: [EXT] HEARTS Scale-Up Investment Case Paper

Dear Kouamivi,

Please find attached the revised health gains manuscript for Paper 1. We have worked through the coauthors' comments on the earlier version, including the three areas I highlighted in August:

1. Updated the blood pressure effect estimates using evidence from the Blood Pressure Lowering Treatment Trialists' Collaboration.

2. Modeled people with and without diabetes as mutually exclusive groups and clarified how the target of 150 million additional people with controlled blood pressure is allocated between them.

3. Added sensitivity analyses and described the scope of the uncertainty analysis more clearly to address the GATHER reporting requirements.

We also revised the mortality projections, corrected the haemorrhagic stroke pathway, and updated the results throughout the manuscript and supplement. Together, these changes lowered the projected health gains relative to the earlier draft.

We would especially welcome WHO's guidance on two assumptions before submission:

1. **Age range for the 150 million target:** Our analysis includes adults aged 20 years and older. Does WHO intend a narrower age range, such as 30–79 years?

2. **Statin eligibility:** For the population count, we currently use adults with diabetes aged 40 years and older as an identifiable high-risk group. This excludes others who may qualify based on overall cardiovascular risk. Does WHO have a preferred eligibility definition or data source?

Either answer could change the results. The analysis and manuscript are built in a reproducible pipeline, so we can rerun the model and update the paper quickly once these assumptions are confirmed.

Please let us know if any of your earlier comments need further attention. David and I would be glad to discuss the revision with you.

Best,

William Garcia
PhD Candidate, Health Metrics & Implementation Science
University of Washington

From: AGBOYIBOR, Kouamivi Mawuenyegan <agboyibork@who.int>
Sent: Tuesday, September 22, 2026 8:48 AM
To: William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>; David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>
Subject: Re: [EXT] HEARTS Scale-Up Investment Case Paper

Fantastic! Thank you so much

From: William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Sent: 22 September 2026 5:45 PM
To: AGBOYIBOR, Kouamivi Mawuenyegan <agboyibork@who.int>; David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>
Subject: Re: [EXT] HEARTS Scale-Up Investment Case Paper

Dear Koamivi,

I hope you're doing well. I'm finalizing the version with uncertainty intervals and ensuring it is compliant with the GATHER guidelines (that is what is pending). I will upload the updated draft by the end of this week.

Best,

William Garcia

PhD Candidate, Health Metrics & Implementation Science

University of Washington

From: AGBOYIBOR, Kouamivi Mawuenyegan <agboyibork@who.int>
Sent: Tuesday, September 22, 2026 8:37 AM
To: David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>; William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Subject: Re: [EXT] HEARTS Scale-Up Investment Case Paper

Dear David,

This is a kind reminder.

Best regards,
Kouamivi

From: AGBOYIBOR, Kouamivi Mawuenyegan <agboyibork@who.int>
Sent: 15 September 2026 10:18 AM
To: David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>; William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Subject: Re: [EXT] HEARTS Scale-Up Investment Case Paper

Dear David,
Dear William,

I hope this meets you well.
I would like to follow up on the corrections needed for the paper 1. Please could you share the updated version this week.

We need to finalize this work.

Thanks,
Kouamivi

From: David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>
Sent: 29 August 2026 12:00 PM
To: AGBOYIBOR, Kouamivi Mawuenyegan <agboyibork@who.int>; William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Subject: Re: [EXT] HEARTS Scale-Up Investment Case Paper

Kouamivi - we have an urgent deadline for another project (time-sensitive request from an MOH) but will get to this by the end of this coming week. Thanks for your patience.

From: AGBOYIBOR, Kouamivi Mawuenyegan <agboyibork@who.int>
Date: Tuesday, August 25, 2026 at 4:57 PM
To: William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Cc: David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>
Subject: Re: [EXT] HEARTS Scale-Up Investment Case Paper

Dear William,

Good morning,
Any update on the first paper as discussed? We really need to move forward.
Thank you,

Kouamivi

From: William R Garcia <wrgg@uw.edu>
Sent: 06 August 2026 5:00 PM
To: AGBOYIBOR, Kouamivi Mawuenyegan <agboyibork@who.int>
Cc: David Watkins <davidaw@uw.edu>
Subject: [EXT] HEARTS Scale-Up Investment Case Paper

Hi Kouamivi,

It was great to meet you today.

We previously worked with Andrew Moran and RTSL team on an investment case for scaling up the HEARTS program. Please see the paper here:
https://www.jacc.org/doi/10.1016/j.jacadv.2025.102412

I thought it might be relevant to your work.

Best,

William Garcia
PhD Candidate, Health Metrics & Implementation Science
University of Washington